

Patient Safety Risk Assessment Guidelines

Purpose

- Risk assessments identify patients who are more likely to experience an adverse event, so preventive steps can be taken early.

Fall Risk Assessment

- Every inpatient is screened on admission using the Morse Fall Scale, which scores history of falling, secondary diagnosis, ambulatory aid, IV therapy, gait, and mental status.
- Patients scoring 'high risk' receive a yellow wristband, a bed alarm, and a bedside fall-prevention sign.
- Reassessment occurs after any fall, transfer, or significant change in condition.

Pressure Injury Risk Assessment

- The Braden Scale is used to assess risk of pressure injuries (bedsores) for all patients with limited mobility.
- High-risk patients receive a turning schedule every 2 hours and a pressure-relieving mattress.

Venous Thromboembolism (VTE) Risk Assessment

- All adult inpatients are assessed for VTE risk within 24 hours of admission using a standardized scoring tool.
- Appropriate prophylaxis (mechanical or pharmacological) is prescribed based on the risk score, unless contraindicated.

Documentation

- All risk assessment scores and the resulting care plan must be documented in the patient's chart and reviewed at every shift change.